

Question 41 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain the concept of Training Needs Assessment (TNA) and state its importance in HRD.

Introduction

Training Needs Assessment (also called Training Needs Analysis) is the systematic study of whether people need training, who needs it, and in what. A simple idea in the notes is: Training and development need = Standard performance – Actual performance — but only when the cause of the gap is lack of knowledge, skill or attitude. If the machine is broken or the target is impossible, that is not a training need. TNA is Stage 1 of the four-stage training cycle: TNA → planning/design → implementation/delivery → evaluation.

Detailed points

- 1. Organisation analysis.** Check the firm's strategies and goals, where performance problems sit, and whether the climate will support training. There must be a link between strategy and T&D. If the firm is cutting a product line, do not train extra people for it.
- 2. Task analysis.** Identify important tasks and the job-related Knowledge, Skills and Attitudes (KSA) that training must emphasise so employees can complete those tasks. This produces the content outline.
- 3. Person analysis.** Compare required KSAs with what each employee actually has. This answers who should sit in the programme. Not everyone with the same job title has the same gap.
- 4. Importance — relevance and avoiding off-the-shelf waste.** Notes warn organisations buy 'off the shelf' programmes without checking applicability. TNA prevents that. HRD money and employee time are scarce.
- 5. Importance — correct diagnosis.** Cause-and-effect analysis first: is training even the answer? TNA protects HRD's honesty and reputation.
- 6. Importance — design quality.** Objectives, methods, level of difficulty, and examples all come from TNA. Without it, design is guesswork.
- 7. Importance — priority and fairness.** Critical jobs and large gaps first. Person analysis also supports equity: those who need help get it, not only favourites.
- 8. Importance — evaluation baseline.** You cannot know if training worked unless you knew the starting gap. TNA writes the success criteria that Kirkpatrick evaluation later uses.

Conclusion. Define TNA, explain three analyses, stress that not every gap is a training need, and list importance: relevance, diagnosis, design, priority, evaluation. TNA is the foundation of professional HRD training.